Chapter-wise Detailed Notes — Nature of Indian federalism

Indian Government & Politics · Unit 2 · Chapter Nature of Indian federalism

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Chapter Study Notes

Learning focus

Federalism divides public authority between levels of government under a constitutional arrangement. Each level has areas of authority that cannot simply be removed by ordinary unilateral action.

1. India has federal features including a written Constitution, division of legislative powers, an independent judiciary and a bicameral Union legislature.

2. Centralising features include residuary powers at the Union level, emergency provisions and constitutional mechanisms through which Union authority can expand in defined circumstances.

3. Cooperative federalism emphasises coordination; competitive federalism emphasises comparison and competition between states. Both can operate in the same system.

4. Whether the system functions fairly depends on political practice, fiscal arrangements, intergovernmental consultation and respect for constitutional boundaries.

Revision checklist

■ Can I define the key concept in my own words?

■ Can I explain its main features and distinguish it from related concepts?

■ Can I support an argument with a relevant example, thinker or constitutional provision?

■ Can I discuss at least one limitation or counterargument?